

Northstar employee onboarding guide

Document ID: ONB-101
Version: 1.4
Effective date: January 15, 2026
Owner: People Operations
Approved by: Head of People
Classification: Internal
Next review: July 15, 2026

1. Who uses this guide

This guide is the working checklist for new employees, their managers, onboarding buddies, and IT. It covers preparation before the start date and the first 30 days. People Operations opens a checklist for each employee and uses that record to track completed tasks, outstanding approvals, and changes to the schedule.

The employee handbook, PPL-001, contains the general expense, travel, and time-off procedures. This guide contains the onboarding deadlines and the home-office allowance. If a task cannot be completed on time, record the blocker in the checklist and notify the owner. Do not mark a task complete while waiting for access or approval.

For onboarding questions, email people@northstar.example. For equipment or account problems, email it@northstar.example. Use your onboarding checklist reference in the subject line when one has been assigned. Never send passwords, authentication codes, or identity documents in an ordinary email reply.

2. Responsibilities

Role	Responsibility
New employee	Complete assigned forms and training, attend scheduled sessions, and flag missing equipment or access.
Manager	Confirm the role, approve required access, arrange introductions, and agree on first-month goals.
People Operations	Send and maintain the checklist, coordinate the welcome session, and verify completion before closure.
IT	Supply approved equipment, help activate accounts, and provision approved access.
Onboarding buddy	Answer everyday questions and schedule first-week check-ins.

Your manager assigns an onboarding buddy. The buddy helps with everyday questions but does not approve expenses, access requests, or time off. Send approval requests to the responsible manager or system owner even if the buddy has helped prepare them.

3. Before your first day

People Operations sends your onboarding checklist five business days before your start date. Complete the checklist and return your signed employment agreement at least two business days before you start. If either item is missing, contact People Operations rather than waiting until the welcome session.

The checklist identifies the forms you need to complete and the secure submission method. Check your name, start date, manager, and contact details for accuracy. Tell People Operations about corrections before signing or submitting records. Keep personal information within the designated process rather than posting it in a team channel.

Your manager confirms the first-week schedule and the introductions relevant to your role. Let the manager know about any scheduling constraints so sessions can be arranged before the start date. Ask for an accessible format or accommodation through People Operations when needed.

IT supplies an approved laptop and a security key. Confirm the delivery details through the process provided by IT. On receipt, check that the equipment is present and undamaged, and keep the packaging until IT confirms setup is complete. Contact IT if a shipment is delayed, an accessory is missing, or the device will not start.

Do not purchase replacement equipment yourself while waiting for a shipment. Contact IT before buying any work equipment; personal equipment purchases without IT approval are not reimbursable.

Pre-start checklist

- Confirm the start date, manager, and welcome-session invitation.
- Return the signed employment agreement at least two business days before starting.
- Complete the pre-start items in the onboarding checklist.
- Confirm equipment delivery and report missing or damaged items.
- Review the first-week calendar and flag conflicts.

4. Your first day

New employees attend a remote welcome session at 9:30 a.m. Eastern Time. The session lasts 45 minutes and covers the company directory, communication tools, and the first-week schedule. Check the invitation in your local time zone; the session time is stated in Eastern Time, including the applicable daylight-saving offset.

IT schedules a separate 30-minute equipment setup session. Have the laptop and security key available. IT will help you activate the company account and confirm that you can reach the tools listed in your checklist. If you cannot join from the company device, use the joining instructions supplied by People Operations and tell IT about the problem.

Session or task	Timing	Preparation
Remote welcome	9:30 a.m. Eastern Time, 45 minutes	Calendar invitation and onboarding checklist.
Equipment setup	Separate IT appointment, 30 minutes	Approved laptop, security key, and a reliable connection.
Manager introduction	Time confirmed by your manager	Role questions and any schedule or access blockers.
Checklist update	Before finishing the day	Record completed sessions and outstanding tasks.

Do not assume that an account login means every requested system is ready. Check the tools needed for your first assignments and record specific failures, including the system name and any error message. Remove sensitive information from screenshots before attaching them to a service-desk request.

5. Account security and customer-data access

Activate your company account and enroll in multifactor authentication before accessing internal systems. Use the supplied security key as your primary authentication method. Follow IT's recovery instructions so you know whom to contact if the key becomes unavailable.

Complete security training within three business days of your start date. Employees must finish training before receiving access to customer data. Your manager must also approve customer-data access; completing training alone does not grant access.

The access request must describe the system, the business reason, and the permissions needed. Your manager reviews the request and IT or the system owner provisions the approved access. Until both training and approval are complete, use only the training environment or materials provided for onboarding. A colleague must not share their login or export customer data to work around a pending request.

Never share passwords or authentication codes. Report a lost laptop or security key to IT immediately. If a message asks you to bypass login controls, approve an unexpected authentication prompt, or send a secret, stop and ask IT to verify the request through the service desk.

Recording completion

Record the security-training completion date in the checklist and attach the completion record where the checklist asks for it. Track manager approval separately from provisioning. If access is approved but not working, leave the task open and add the IT request number so the manager can follow up without creating a duplicate request.

6. Your first week

Meet with your manager to agree on three goals for your first 30 days. Record the goals in your onboarding checklist by the end of your fifth business day. Each goal should name a deliverable or observable outcome, the person who will review it, and any access or support required.

A useful first-month goal might be to complete a supervised workflow and document the result in the team project record. Avoid goals that depend on an unapproved customer-data export or a production change before the required training. If an assignment is blocked, your manager should adjust the work or arrange an approved alternative.

Your onboarding buddy schedules two check-ins during your first week. Each check-in lasts 20 minutes. Bring questions about how the team works, where documents are kept, and which recurring meetings matter for your role. Send approval requests and sensitive employment questions to the responsible owner instead of asking the buddy to resolve them.

Before the week ends, review the checklist with your manager. Confirm that your first-month goals are recorded and that each unresolved task has an owner. An item such as "access pending" should include the system and request number so another person can act on it.

7. Home-office allowance

Employees working remotely may request a one-time home-office allowance of up to \$250. Obtain written manager approval before purchasing eligible items, keep itemized receipts, and submit the reimbursement request within 30 calendar days of purchase. The allowance covers a total of up to \$250, not \$250 for each item.

Eligible items are a keyboard, mouse, monitor, and desk lamp. Desks, chairs, and internet bills are not covered by this allowance. The allowance does not authorize employees to purchase laptops; IT supplies approved laptops and must be contacted before any work-equipment purchase.

Item	Covered by the allowance?	Action before purchase
Keyboard or mouse	Yes, within the remaining \$250 total	Obtain written manager approval; confirm compatibility with IT where needed.
Monitor	Yes, within the remaining \$250 total	Obtain written manager approval and check the connection requirements.
Desk lamp	Yes, within the remaining \$250 total	Obtain written manager approval.
Desk or chair	No	Do not submit under this allowance.
Internet bill	No	Do not submit under this allowance.
Laptop	No; supplied by IT	Contact IT.

Submit eligible purchases through the expense process under EXP-042. Attach the written approval and itemized receipts, and identify the request as the ONB-101 home-office allowance. Finance reviews complete requests within five business days under the employee handbook. Review does not guarantee payment on the same day.

If a purchase contains both eligible and ineligible items, identify the eligible line items and request only the eligible amount. Ask Finance before claiming a replacement or a second purchase if you are unsure how much of the one-time allowance remains.

8. Your first month and 30-day review

Your manager schedules a 30-day review to discuss your onboarding goals and any remaining access or training needs. Update the goals before the meeting with completed work, links to the deliverables, and a short explanation of any blocker. The review is also the place to clarify work priorities and agree on the next set of assignments.

People Operations checks that your onboarding checklist is complete before closing it. Open access requests, missing training records, or incomplete forms should remain visible until the responsible owner confirms completion. Closure of the checklist does not replace ongoing security training or later access reviews.

Completion record

The checklist should contain the following before it is closed:

- Returned agreement and completed required forms.
- Welcome and equipment-setup attendance.
- Security-training completion record.
- Required access approvals and confirmation that provisioning is complete.
- Three first-month goals and the manager's review notes.
- Any remaining issue, with a named owner and follow-up date.

9. Onboarding case note

Morgan starts on Monday, March 2, 2026. People Operations sends the checklist five business days before that date. Morgan returns the signed agreement at least two business days before starting and joins the first-day welcome session at 9:30 a.m. Eastern Time.

Morgan completes security training within the first three business days, then waits for manager approval and provisioning before accessing customer data. The buddy's confirmation that training is finished does not authorize access.

Morgan requests a \$180 monitor for a home office. The monitor is eligible for the allowance, but Morgan obtains written manager approval before buying it and submits an itemized receipt within 30 calendar days of the purchase. Assuming no other purchases have used the allowance, \$70 remains available for eligible items under the same one-time allowance.

10. Revision record

Versio n	Effective date	Change
1.4	January 15, 2026	Clarified access prerequisites, checklist closure, and the combined home-office allowance limit.

People Operations owns corrections to this guide. Include ONB-101 and the relevant section number when reporting a missing instruction or a conflict with the checklist.